

STOP THINKING
ABOUT RECRUITING.
START THINKING ABOUT
REPS.



WHEN PARENTS GO TO COLLEGE CAMPS, THEY'RE THINKING ABOUT RECRUITING. THE SMARTER FRAME IS HIGH-QUALITY TRAINING REPS.

THE SERIES

FIVE LESSONS. ONE PLAYER.

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Stop Thinking About Recruiting, Start Thinking About Reps

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What College Coaches Bring to a Camp

Coming up.

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Private Training and Independent Facilities: The Same Standard Applies

Coming up.

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The Environment Matters: Training Meets Life

Coming up.

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Building the High-Quality Rep Habit For Life

Coming up.

HEAR THIS ONCE

PARENTS WHO APPROACH COLLEGE
CAMPS AS RECRUITING
OPPORTUNITIES ARE OPTIMIZING
FOR THE WRONG OUTCOME.

College coaches are there to coach. The quality of instruction available at a college camp — from coaches whose full-time job is developing elite volleyball players — is unlike anything available in the club system. The smart play is to show up hungry to learn, not desperate to impress.

— REPS OVER RECRUITING · MAZEPERFORMANCE

IF YOUR ATHLETE SHOWS UP TO
A COLLEGE CAMP THINKING
ABOUT RECRUITING, SHE MISSES
THE BEST COACHING SHE'S EVER
GOING TO GET.

- College coaches' full-time job is volleyball — their quality of instruction is unmatched
- The reps available at a college camp are elite development opportunities, not auditions
- The athlete who shows up to learn gets more out of the experience than the one who shows up to perform

— SHOW UP TO LEARN. THE RECRUITING TAKES CARE OF ITSELF.

05 · THE BREAKDOWN

WHY COLLEGE COACHES ARE DIFFERENT

FULL FOCUS

Their entire professional life is volleyball: bandwidth, time, money, and attention all go there.

DEEP EXPERIENCE

Decades of experience, at the highest level: they have seen every pattern and know every fix.

EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE

They coach athletes through major life transitions: their EQ is significantly higher than most youth coaches.



THE CAMP MINDSET

IN PRACTICE

Brief your athlete before any college camp: 'You are here for the reps and the coaching. Not the evaluation.'

WATCH FOR

Whether she performs for the coaches or learns from them, the former closes the coaching window.

THE SHIFT

From evaluation mindset to learning mindset, and watch the quality of the reps change.



SAVE THIS COME BACK TO IT

THE ATHLETE WHO SHOWS UP
HUNGRY TO LEARN WILL WALK AWAY
WITH MORE THAN THE ONE WHO
SHOWS UP TRYING TO IMPRESS.

SAVE THIS. COME BACK TO IT.

THIS WEEK

THIS WEEK, REFRAME THE COLLEGE CAMP OPPORTUNITY.

✓ If a college camp is upcoming, brief your athlete: 'We are going for the coaching. Not the recruiting.'

✓ Ask: 'What specific skill do you most want to work on with a college-level coach?'

✓ After the camp: 'What's the most useful thing you were told?'

✓ Make the rep, not the perceived evaluation, the measure of success



WHAT COLLEGE COACHES BRING TO A CAMP

02

DECADES OF EXPERIENCE. TACTICAL DEPTH. AND A RARE LEVEL OF EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE.



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PARENTS UNDERESTIMATE WHAT A COLLEGE COACH BRINGS TO A TRAINING CAMP BEYOND TECHNICAL INSTRUCTION.

A college coach is not just a better technical instructor. She is someone who has guided hundreds of athletes through the transition from youth sport to elite competition, from high school to college, from player to adult. That perspective is available at a camp, if your athlete is open to it.

— THE COACHING DEPTH AT THE COLLEGE LEVEL IS UNMATCHED · MAZEPERFORMANCE

WHAT THEY BRING

A COLLEGE CAMP IS NOT JUST ABOUT HITTING AND PASSING. IT'S ABOUT ACCESSING A LEVEL OF COACHING DEPTH THAT DOESN'T EXIST ANYWHERE ELSE AT THIS STAGE.

- Tactical complexity: college coaches see the game at a level that transforms how athletes understand it
- Developmental context: they've guided players through every stage — they know what comes next
- Mental performance: their athletes are away from home, under pressure, in transition — their EQ is built for this

— THE BEST COACHING EXPOSURE AVAILABLE AT THIS LEVEL IS A COLLEGE CAMP. USE IT.

THE THREE LEVELS

TECHNICAL

Serving mechanics, passing angles, blocking reads: the physical craft at the highest youth-accessible level.

TACTICAL

System understanding, team positioning, match strategy: the game at a level of complexity that club rarely reaches.

MENTAL

How to handle transition, pressure, failure, and growth: from coaches who've seen all of it.



ACCESSING ALL THREE LEVELS

IN PRACTICE

Brief your athlete to ask questions at every level — not just 'can you correct my serving?' but 'how do you handle a player who freezes under pressure?'

WATCH FOR

Whether she leaves with technical corrections only or with a deeper understanding of how the game works.

THE SHIFT

From treating the camp as a skills clinic to treating it as a rare access point to elite coaching perspective.



07 · REMEMBER THIS

SAVE THIS COME BACK TO IT

THIS IS RARE ACCESS. SHOW UP
WITH QUESTIONS THAT GO DEEPER
THAN MECHANICS.

SAVE THIS. COME BACK TO IT.

— THE ACCESS LAW

THIS WEEK

THIS WEEK, PREPARE THREE QUESTIONS FOR THE NEXT CAMP.

✓ With your athlete, prepare three questions for the college coaches: one technical, one tactical, one mental

✓ Write them down: that's the commitment

✓ After the camp: 'Did you ask your questions? What were the answers?'

✓ Add one insight from each question to her development arc



PRIVATE TRAINING AND INDEPENDENT FACILITIES: THE SAME STANDARD APPLIES

03

FULL-TIME COACHES — WHETHER AT A COLLEGE OR A PRIVATE FACILITY — BRING A DIFFERENT DEPTH. LEARN TO ACCESS IT.

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PARENTS OFTEN OVERLOOK PRIVATE TRAINING FACILITIES AS INFERIOR TO COLLEGE EXPOSURE, WHEN IN MANY CASES, THE COACHING DEPTH IS EQUIVALENT.

The people who own and operate independent training facilities are, like college coaches, doing volleyball as their full-time professional focus. Their motivation is the same: developing athletes at a high level. The access is easier to get. The quality, when the facility is right, is just as high.

— Way Point · FULL-TIME COACHES CHANGE THE DEVELOPMENT TRAJECTORY · MAZEPERFORMANCE

THE FACILITY ADVANTAGE

IF A COACH'S FULL-TIME JOB IS
DEVELOPING YOUR ATHLETE, SHE
HAS EVERY INCENTIVE TO DO IT
WELL. SEEK THAT.

- Independent facilities: full focus, strong motivation, often more accessible than a college camp
- Evaluation criteria: what is the coach's background? Is this her full-time focus? What's the athlete-to-coach ratio?
- The standard: any full-time coach focused on mental and physical development is worth accessing

— SEEK COACHES FOR WHOM THIS IS THE FULL-TIME JOB. THE DIFFERENCE IS MEASURABLE.

EVALUATING A FACILITY

CREDENTIALS

What is the coach's playing and coaching background? Is this their primary professional focus?

RATIOS

How many athletes per coach? More than 10:1 and the individual development potential drops significantly.

MENTAL PERFORMANCE

Does the facility include mental skills training alongside physical? This is the standard to look for.



FINDING THE RIGHT FIT

IN PRACTICE

Ask these questions before committing to any training program: Who is the coach? What is their full-time focus? What is the athlete-to-coach ratio?

WATCH FOR

Facilities that promise results without a clear methodology: quality facilities explain the how, not just the what.

THE SHIFT

From choosing training based on convenience to choosing it based on coaching quality and developmental depth.

07 · REMEMBER THIS

SAVE THIS COME BACK TO IT

THE BEST TRAINING INVESTMENT YOU
CAN MAKE IS A FULL-TIME COACH
WHO IS SINGULARLY FOCUSED ON
DEVELOPING YOUR ATHLETE.

SAVE THIS. COME BACK TO IT.

— THE QUALITY LAW

THIS WEEK

THIS WEEK, EVALUATE ONE TRAINING INVESTMENT.

✓ Review one current training environment: what is the coach's full-time focus?

✓ Ask about the athlete-to-coach ratio and what the session structure looks like

✓ Identify the gap: what is your athlete getting and what is she not getting?

✓ Make one strategic adjustment based on what the quality evaluation reveals



THE ENVIRONMENT MATTERS: TRAINING MEETS LIFE



WHEN THE TRAINING ENVIRONMENT ITSELF IS AN INVESTMENT IN THE WHOLE PERSON, THE DEVELOPMENT GOES DEEPER.

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THE BEST TRAINING EXPERIENCES ARE NOT JUST ABOUT THE VOLLEYBALL. THEY ARE ABOUT THE ENVIRONMENT, THE ENERGY, AND THE FULLNESS OF THE EXPERIENCE AROUND THE SPORT.

Elite performers know that recovery, environment, and quality of life outside of training directly impact the quality of training. A camp or experience designed with the whole person in mind, athlete and parent, creates a different outcome than one that treats athletes as machines to be optimized.

— Way Point · THE ENVIRONMENT IS PART OF THE DEVELOPMENT · MAZEPERFORMANCE

THE WHOLE EXPERIENCE

THE BEST TRAINING EXPERIENCES
INVEST IN THE WHOLE ATHLETE
AND THE WHOLE FAMILY. THAT
INVESTMENT PAYS DIVIDENDS.

- Recovery: rest, quality food, and beautiful environments between sessions improve the quality of sessions
- Parent experience: a parent who is nourished and inspired during the camp is a better partner afterward
- Culture: an experience designed with intentionality creates memories that motivate long after the camp ends

— THE BEST TRAINING ENVIRONMENTS DEVELOP THE WHOLE PERSON, NOT JUST THE PLAYER.

WHAT MAKES AN EXPERIENCE ELITE

INTENTIONAL RECOVERY

Great sleep, quality food, beautiful surroundings, these are not luxuries. They are performance inputs.

PARENT INVESTMENT

When parents are also nourished and engaged, they show up differently for their athletes at home.

MEMORY

An experience that the athlete remembers with joy creates a reference point for what excellence feels like.



INVESTING IN THE WHOLE EXPERIENCE

IN PRACTICE

When evaluating a camp or experience, ask: what does the environment offer beyond the court?

WATCH FOR

Whether the experience builds the athlete as a whole person or just as a volleyball player.

THE SHIFT

From seeking the most intense training to seeking the most complete development experience.



SAVE THIS COME BACK TO IT

THE DEVELOPMENT THAT HAPPENS
OFF THE COURT, IN THE RECOVERY,
THE ENVIRONMENT, THE EXPERIENCE:
MAKES THE COURT WORK LAND
DEEPER.

SAVE THIS. COME BACK TO IT.

— THE WHOLE PERSON LAW

THIS WEEK

THIS WEEK, EVALUATE ONE UPCOMING DEVELOPMENT EXPERIENCE.

✓ Look at the next camp or training investment: does it develop the whole person?

✓ Identify what it offers on and off the court

✓ Ask: 'Is my athlete likely to walk away remembering this as a formative experience?'

✓ If not, look for one that comes closer to that standard



BUILDING THE HIGH-QUALITY REP HABIT FOR LIFE

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THE ATHLETE WHO SEEKS HIGH-QUALITY REPS BECOMES THE PROFESSIONAL WHO SEEKS HIGH-QUALITY MENTORSHIP.



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HEAR THIS ONCE

THE HABIT OF SEEKING OUT THE BEST COACHING AND MENTORSHIP AVAILABLE AT EACH STAGE OF DEVELOPMENT IS ONE OF THE MOST POWERFUL HABITS AN ATHLETE CAN BUILD.

Elite performers at every level share one behavior: they consistently seek coaching and learning from people who are operating at a higher level than they currently are. Building this habit in a youth athlete is building a success habit that transfers into every domain.

— SEEK THE BEST COACHING AVAILABLE AT EVERY STAGE · MAZEPERFORMANCE

THE MENTORSHIP HABIT

THE ATHLETE WHO LEARNS TO
SEEK HIGH-QUALITY MENTORSHIP
AT EVERY STAGE BECOMES THE
ADULT WHO DOES THE SAME.

- Youth volleyball: seeking out the best available coaching with a learning mindset
- College transition: actively building relationships with coaches, professors, and mentors
- Professional life: the same habit — who is operating at the next level and how do I access them?

— THE HABIT OF SEEKING BETTER COACHING IS THE HABIT OF SEEKING BETTER. FULL STOP.

THE HABIT ACROSS DOMAINS

SPORT

Seeking college camps, quality private training, high-level competition: all reps, all learning.

EDUCATION

Asking the best teachers questions. Seeking tutors and mentors. Not just completing assignments.

LIFE

The adult who knows how to seek out quality guidance in any domain she enters is ahead of the curve.



N A M I N G T H E H A B I T

IN PRACTICE

After a college camp or high-quality training experience, make the habit explicit: 'This is what it looks like to seek out the best.'



WATCH FOR

Whether she is beginning to identify quality coaching opportunities independently, that's the habit emerging.

THE SHIFT

From parent-directed access to high-quality coaching to athlete-directed pursuit of it.



07 · REMEMBER THIS

SAVE THIS COME BACK TO IT

TEACH HER TO SEEK THE BEST
AVAILABLE COACHING AT EVERY
STAGE. SHE WILL USE THAT HABIT
FOR THE REST OF HER LIFE.

SAVE THIS. COME BACK TO IT.

— THE PURSUIT LAW

THIS WEEK

THIS WEEK, NAME THE HABIT.

✓ After any high-quality coaching experience, name what just happened: 'That is what it looks like to seek out the best.'

✓ Ask: 'Where else in your life could you do the same thing?'

✓ Help her identify one non-volleyball domain where she could seek higher-quality mentorship

✓ Celebrate when she takes that initiative independently, that's the habit taking root

